

2000 - 88

CFO-RC F

RESULTS: 7-0A

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

(Please print or type. Attach photographs, drawings, and additional pages if necessary.)

Species: Scissor-tailed Flycatcher
(Common Name)Tyrannus forficatus
(Scientific Name)Date(s) of observation: May 16 2000Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Female Plumage: AdultExact location: Pickney Road 1 1/2 miles south of its junction with Cedarwood Rd.County: Pueblo Nearest town: Colorado City Elevation: 5800 feetLength of observation: 5 minutes Times(s) of observation: 8:15 - 8:20 AMOther observers who saw the bird(s) with you: NoneOther observers who independently saw the bird(s): NoneLight conditions (quality; direction relative to bird's; position): Good light - bird north of observerOptical equipment used: 10x40 Zeiss binocularDistance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 30 yardsWas bird photographed?: No If so, have you submitted photographs? _____

Who took the photographs? _____

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred:

Hilly pasture land with thin stands of juniper and piñon pine trees.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying; feeding; habits; behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

Bird perched on barbed wire fence with brief periods of flight and then a return to perch on fence.

Describe the bird(s) in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include overall size and shape, and how you placed the bird(s) in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings, and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Describe other details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches, or copy of field notes):

This bird's head and body were primarily whitish with brownish-buff belly. Wings were black but fringed with white feather edgings. Tail was black with white outer tail feathers. Tail was nearly twice bird's body length and deeply forked. Eye and legs were black. Bill was short, slim, and black. I did not get a good look at axillaries.

Describe bird's call or song:

None given

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Mockingbird is gray with long tail but its tail is rounded and not deeply forked. Scissor-tails lack white wing patches of Mockingbird. Mockingbird's belly is whitish.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I have seen many Scissor-tailed Flycatchers and Mockingbirds. Because of its proportionately longer tail, adult Scissor-tails are actually longer in length than Mockingbirds.

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your identification (during and after observation):

National Geographic Field Guide to Birds of N. AmericaThis report was made from notes made during ☒ or after ☐ observation, ☐ and later from memory ☒.Date of written report: 5-16-2000Reporting observer: David Silverman Signature: David A. SilvermanObserver's address: P.O. Box 362 Rye CO 81069Send report to: Bill Lisowsky, 2919 Silverplume Drive, Fort Collins, Colorado 80526